970
MILLION
Size of the Indian electorate

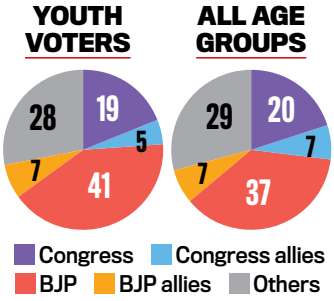
210
MILLION
Voters in the 18-29 age group, 22 per cent of total voters

153
MILLION
Estimated number of youth who voted in the 2019 election

63
MILLION
or 41 per cent youth voted for the BJP in 2019; 19 per cent for the Congress

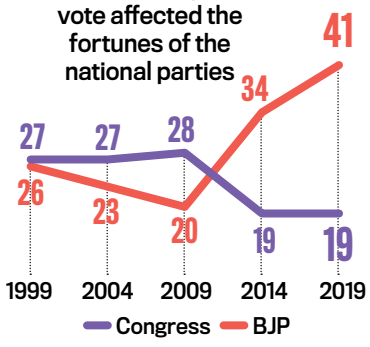
THEIR VOTE IN 2019

The BJP had more voters among the youth than the national average



HOW THE GAP WIDENED

The swing in youth vote affected the fortunes of the national parties



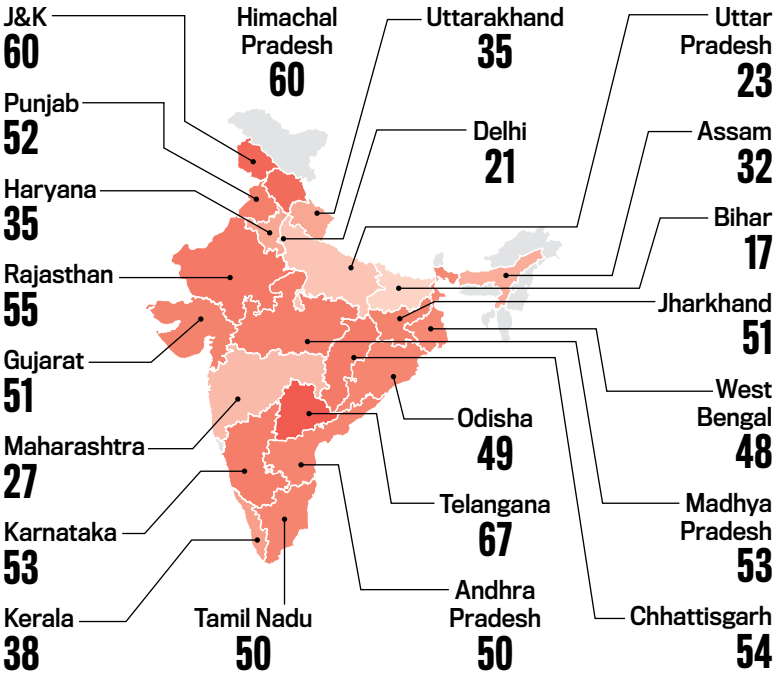
Figures in percentage
Source: The Youth Vote in Lok Sabha Elections 2019, Lokniti-CSDS

VOTE OF INDIFFERENCE

Only 38 per cent of those who turned 18 or 19 have enrolled to vote in 2024. Youth in Bihar, Delhi, Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra and Assam are least interested in voting

Estimated population of 18-19 age group **49 MN**

Enlisted as voters **18.4 MN**



Figures denote percentage of enlisted voters for 2024 LS elections among the 18-19-year-old; *Source: Election Commission of India*

an analysis by the London-based political scientist Oliver Heath the following year documented, it did even better in 2019, gaining seven percentage points, to take its vote share among the youth to 41 per cent, according to the Lokniti-CSDS study. This election, too, the BJP is reaching out to the first-time voter, with the prime minister himself appealing to the 18-19-year-olds

Of the 110 million difference in the BJP and Congress votes in 2019, 57 per cent was on account of the youth voting saffron

to exercise their franchise. "Please vote to secure your future for the next 25 years," he said, addressing the country's young constituents directly in a recent television interview, at the end of which rainbow he is promising a 'Viksit Bharat' or a developed India. The prime minister calls them the 'Amrit Peedhi' or the golden generation. They are really Gen V, or Generation Viksit Bharat,

Graphics by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY